Abdulmajid P. Marohombsar

Atty. Abdulmajid P. Marohombsar — more warmly known as **Atty. Majid** in the circles he moves through — is a Maranao Muslim lawyer, educator, and policy advocate from Lanao del Sur who has built his career at the intersection of two legal worlds that don't always speak to each other: the Philippine national justice system and the Shari'ah tradition that governs the lives of millions of Muslim Filipinos.

He's the kind of figure who's harder to spot on a headline but impossible to miss in the rooms where policy gets shaped. In September 2024, the Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP) appointed him as the first-ever Deputy Director for Muslim Concerns at the National Center for Legal Aid (NCLA) — a historic appointment that put a dedicated Muslim legal aid office inside the IBP's national structure for the first time.

His work spans courtrooms, classrooms, and policy tables — from litigating in both regular and Shari'ah courts, to teaching at the Philippine Judicial Academy, to writing on Islamic finance instruments like Sukuk, to sitting in on summits that quietly shape how justice reaches the Bangsamoro region.

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Background

Marohombsar comes from a Maranao family with roots planted deep in Lanao del Sur — the heartland of Maranao culture, framed by Lake Lanao and the skyline of Marawi City.

He grew up shaped by the particular texture of Muslim Mindanao: a region of extraordinary cultural richness, long-running conflict, slow peace, and a community that has had to fight hard just to be seen and served by its own national institutions.

His parents — Mr. Saidamen Tamano Marohombsar and Mrs. Almirah Pandapatan Marohombsar — are central figures in how he talks about his life and work. He credits them with the quiet, foundational kind of support that rarely makes it into official biographies: "infinite love" and real sacrifices that made his path possible. He's invoked the Islamic legal principle that *hardship begets facility* — a phrase that reads like a window into the values they passed on to him.

The Marohombsar name carries weight in Mindanao's professional and academic networks, connecting to generations of figures in education and public service. But what stands out in how he talks about himself isn't lineage — it's gratitude, and a sense that everything he's been given creates an obligation to give back.

Education

If there's one thing that defines Marohombsar's formation as a lawyer and thinker, it's the sheer range of where he chose to study — and what that range says about the kind of work he was preparing himself for.

He earned his Juris Doctor in the Philippines and cleared both the Philippine Bar and the Shari'ah Bar — a dual qualification that very few Filipino lawyers hold, and that sits at the core of what makes his IBP role possible.

For graduate-level Islamic scholarship, he went to the University of the Philippines Diliman, where he earned a Master of Arts in Islamic Studies (MAIS) — and did it as a university scholar, which says something about how seriously he brought himself to the work.

He also trained at the Hague Academy of International Law in the Netherlands, one of the most prestigious institutions in international legal education. He took his Islamic finance studies to INCEIF University in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia — a specialized institution that trains professionals in the technical frameworks of Islamic banking and capital markets.

And he's not done. He's currently a candidate for a Master of Public Policy at the London School of Economics — signaling that he sees law not just as a courtroom craft but as a tool for shaping systems and governance.

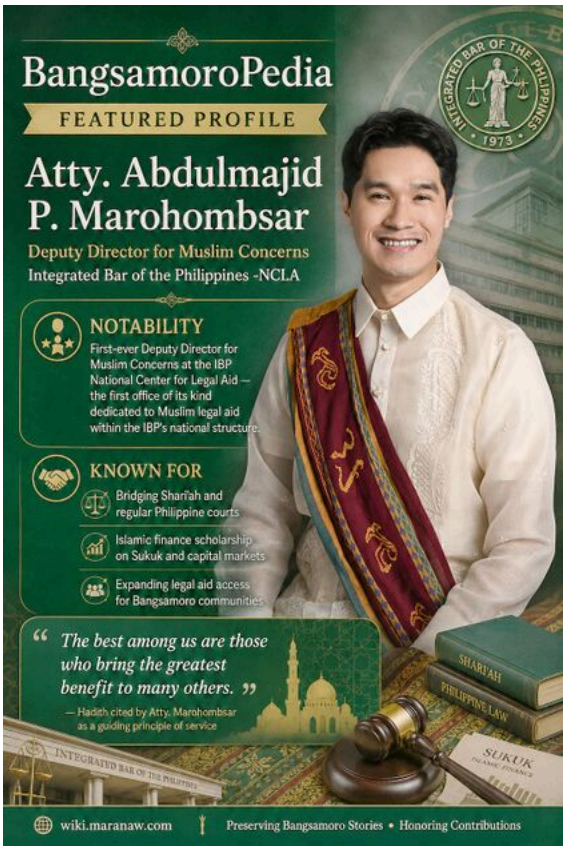
On top of all that, he serves as a professorial lecturer at the Philippine Judicial Academy in the Department of Shari'ah and Islamic Laws and Jurisprudence — which means he's not just absorbing the law, he's teaching the judges and court practitioners who apply it.

Career

Marohombsar's career doesn't fit neatly into one category — and that's probably intentional.

He's worked in both government and the private sector, including roles with the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF), which gives him firsthand familiarity with the institutional landscape that shapes Muslim Filipino life from the policy side.

He's also an author. His written work on Sukuk — the Islamic bond instrument — and on Islamic capital markets puts him in a relatively small group of Filipino legal scholars who understand

Atty. Abdulmajid P. Marohombsar

Full Name
Abdulmajid P. Marohombsar
Also Known As
Atty. Majid; Abdul Majid Marohombsar
Ethnicity
Maranao (Muslim Filipino)
Region of Origin
Lanao del Sur, BARMM, Philippines
Professions
Lawyer; Educator; Policy Advocate
Specializations
Shari'ah Law; Islamic finance; Access to Justice
Current Position
Deputy Director for Muslim Concerns, IBP National Center for Legal Aid (NCLA)

Islamic finance not just in theory but in its technical and regulatory dimensions. That expertise matters increasingly as the Philippines looks at integrating Islamic finance into its broader financial architecture.

But the appointment that marks the clearest milestone in his career came in September 2024, when the IBP named him Deputy Director for Muslim Concerns at the National Center for Legal Aid. The NCLA is the IBP's primary legal aid arm, and this new office within it represents something that hadn't existed before: a structured, institutionalized pathway for Muslim Filipinos — especially those in remote or conflict-affected areas of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) — to access legal help in both regular courts and Shari'ah courts.

The position aligns directly with ongoing reforms from the Supreme Court to improve access to justice, and Marohombsar has been active in making it more than a title — participating in Shari'ah summits, legal aid caravans, and collaborative work between the IBP, NCMF, and the judiciary.

Appointed
September 2024
Bar Memberships
Philippine Bar; Shari'ah Bar
Education
Juris Doctor (JD); MAIS, University of the Philippines Diliman; Hague Academy of International Law; INCEIF University, Kuala Lumpur; MPP Candidate, London School of Economics
Parents
Mr. Saidamen Tamano Marohombsar; Mrs. Almirah Pandapatan Marohombsar
Notability
First-ever Deputy Director for Muslim Concerns at the IBP National Center for Legal Aid — the first office of its kind dedicated to Muslim legal aid within the IBP's national structure.
Known For
Bridging Shari'ah and regular Philippine courts; Islamic finance scholarship on Sukuk and capital markets; expanding legal aid access for Bangsamoro communities
Pull Quote
"The best among us are those who bring the greatest benefit to many others." — Hadith cited by Atty. Marohombsar as a guiding principle of service

Institutional Contributions

The deeper significance of Marohombsar's IBP role is what it represents structurally: for the first time, there's a formal Muslim legal aid office inside the country's national lawyers' organization.

Muslim Filipinos have long navigated a dual legal reality — the national civil and criminal law system on one side, and the Code of Muslim Personal Laws on the other, which governs family matters, inheritance, and personal status under Shari'ah principles. For communities in Mindanao, especially in the BARMM, the gap between legal rights on paper and legal access in practice has historically been wide.

Marohombsar's work is aimed at closing that gap. His office supports cases in both legal systems, helps communities understand their rights, and builds the connective tissue between institutions that too often operated in silos.

He's also contributed to the broader peace-building conversation in Mindanao, approaching it through the lens of legal inclusion: the idea that genuine peace requires not just absence of conflict but presence of justice, and that justice has to be accessible to be real.

His connections to institutions like Mindanao State University (MSU) and networks across the Muslim Filipino professional community strengthen his ability to translate policy work into on-the-ground impact.

Legacy

Atty. Marohombsar represents something that's still uncommon in the Philippine legal establishment: a lawyer who's equally at home in a Manila courtroom, a Shari'ah court in Mindanao, a lecture hall at the Judicial Academy, and an international law seminar in The Hague.

That range isn't accidental. It reflects a deliberate choice to build the kind of credibility and competence that makes it harder for institutions to ignore the communities he serves.

He's become a model for younger Maranao and Muslim Filipino professionals — proof that a person can be deeply rooted in Islamic identity and tradition while also moving fluently through the highest levels of national and international legal education. He doesn't treat those two things as contradictions. He treats them as the whole point.

His reference to the hadith — "the best among us are those who bring the greatest benefit to many others" — isn't just a quote. It functions as a mission statement. And in a country where Muslim Filipinos have spent decades pushing for recognition, representation, and a justice system that actually serves them, Marohombsar's quiet, rigorous, institution-building work is exactly the kind of contribution that outlasts headlines.

Recognition

- Appointed first-ever Deputy Director for Muslim Concerns at the IBP National Center for Legal Aid (September 2024)
- University Scholar, Master of Arts in Islamic Studies, University of the Philippines Diliman
- Fellow/Participant, Hague Academy of International Law, The Hague, Netherlands
- Professorial Lecturer, Philippine Judicial Academy, Department of Shari'ah and Islamic Laws and Jurisprudence
- Dual bar qualifier: Philippine Bar and Shari'ah Bar

Categories

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